

THIMUN RULES OF PROCEDURE

THIMUN stands for The Hague International Model United Nations has specific guidelines that must be followed when one wants to make an action.

FLOW OF DEBATE

1. Roll Call

- Present: can vote Yes, No or Abstain
- Present and Voting: can only vote Yes or No

2. Opening Speech. This allows the speaker to announce their stance to other delegates

- Talk about your country's policy on the issue
- Keep it concise: 1 minute long

3. Lobbying. This is the fun part. This can done through moderated or unmoderated caucus

- Moderated caucus: controlled by the chair
 - i. delegate who motioned sets the total time , time per speaker as well as topic to discuss
 - 1. "this delegate would like to motion for a 10 minute moderated caucus with 1 minute per speaker about the dangers of nuclear energy"
- Unmoderated caucus: delegates can talk/discuss with other delegates freely

4. Debate Procedure

- Main submitter delivers the speech on the resolution
- Points of Information (a fancy phrase for questions). The chair asks the speaker at the end of her speech: "Is the delegate open to any POI?"
 - i. Any and all. Unlimited POI
 - ii. Specific number. You can only accommodate 1 or 2 POIs.
- **Points**
 - i. Point of Information: question to the speaker
 - ii. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry: question to the chair about the procedure
 - iii. Point of Clarification: delegate to ask for further explanation
- **Motions**
 - i. Motion to introduce resolution
 - ii. Motion to set a debate
 - iii. Motion for a right to reply
 - iv. Motion to move to previous question
 - v. Motion to divide the house
 - vi. Motion to go for voting procedure
- **Yields**
 - i. Yield to the chair. No need to speak further
 - ii. Yield to question. Allows a delegate to ask a question
 - iii. Yield to another delegate. Give remaining time to another delegate

5. Amendment Procedure

- Write down the clause/subclause you wish to amend to a note.
- Submit the amendment to the chair
- Raise placard to open a speech - "motion to raise an amendment"
- Chairs can ask for more speakers

6. Voting.

- All procedural voting requires a simple majority ($\frac{1}{2} + 1$)
- Draft resolutions and amendments require a $\frac{2}{3}$ vote

1. Can be used against opposing blocs/ to support your own bloc.

"Is there sufficient evidence to ensure the success of the delegate's policies?"

"The delegate has mentioned accepting refugees as part of their solution, however, ther**How to POI ?**

POIs are simply questions, so they take on many forms. The examples listed below are some very common ones you can use , but you can tailor them to your MUN experience and topics.

2. Defining specifics

"The delegate mentioned that they plan to provide baby bonuses, this delegate would like to ask who exactly is going to provide funding?"

3. Definition

" The delegate had mentioned Teleworking, this delegate would like to ask for its official definition?"

4. Clarifications

" The delegate has stated that they would like to continue providing funding for nuclear power, does this mean that the delegate is for the reopening of closed power plants?"

"Could the delegate explain their policy towards this issue and how it is going to function?"

5. Defining blocs and stances

" The delegate has mentioned that they are against nuclear power -citing security issues. What measures would the delegate like to see to make them more amenable to nuclear power?"

"The delegate says that their nation supports rights for all, however in 2016 their nation passed multiple laws against minority groups. Has the situation changed since then?"

e is nothing to support the refugees after they arrive in the country. What is the delegate's plan for this"

"What does the delegate think are the most important clauses to focus on to solve this crisis"

TIPS:

1. Take down notes while people are speaking
2. Analyze
 - a. Word choices usually are very deliberate. So if they are highly specific or use any words that seem complicated. Those words or phrases can easily be POIs
 - b. Look for subtle meanings to find out the delegate's stances / get them to accidentally agree with you etc
3. Focus

- a. Refer to 1
 - b. Sometimes they may deliberately drown their main point in fancy words or rush over them. This could possibly mean that they aren't all that confident in that point. This is an opportunity to ask
- 4. Don't overthink
 - a. Anything relevant to the speech or topic can be asked. Don't think you have to sound super smart with your question.
- 5. Avoid Yes / No questions
 - a. I mean technically you can ask them, it's hard to gain much from it.

COMMON PHRASES

Phrase	Meaning
“Is it in order to . . .”	Is it allowed to
“It is in order to . . .”	It will be allowed
“It is not in order to . . .”	It won't be allowed
“Debate Time”	Time set for this debate
“Time Constraints”	Restriction of time
“Request for Follow up?”	Can I ask an additional question?
“Yield the Floor”	Give the floor to someone else
“That will be Entertained”	That will be allowed to happen
“That won't be Entertained”	That won't be allowed to happen

SAMPLE OPENING SPEECH AND STRUCTURE

Honorable chairs and fellow delegates,

In 1945, the United Nations was formed in the aftermath of WW2 with the fundamental purpose of protecting people from violence and conflict. Today, as the Security Council we come together to uphold this duty to the world.

The Russian - Ukraine crisis has been ongoing since 2014 and seemed to be on the path to a silent, semi-peaceful resolution. However within a few short weeks, it has escalated from whispers of a possible invasion to a live war. Ukraine is now in its 2nd week of war and in that time, both sides suffered casualties.

The human cost of this war is too great. Over 1 million Ukrainians have fled to nearby nations while over 2,000 civilians and counting have died.

Brazil is calling for immediate humanitarian aid to Ukraine. The lives of innocent civilians have been uprooted by this crisis. Thus to limit bloodshed, space for neutral , impartial and independent humanitarian action must be protected at all costs.

Moreover, Brazil calls for the de-escalation of this war. Continuing on will only harm the world, with many countries already suffering from inflation of many essential products - most prominent within Russia.

Brazil is looking forward to all the varied solutions of the delegates.

TIP: you don't have to make your speeches exactly like this, but make sure you have the three key things : Exposition , Why it's important and Solutions.

Note: In MUN, you don't refer to yourself as you because you're representing a country. You aren't allowed to use personal pronouns (such as I, you, me). Instead use this delegate, that delegate, the delegate of [your country], [country]. ex. Brazil would like to propose... This delegate believes ... The delegate of China reiterates and etc. Look at the sample!

RESOLUTIONS

The resolution is the ultimate goal of any MUN conference and is where you'll pursue your proposed solutions to the issues at hand. There are 2 main parts of a resolution : preambulatory clauses and operative clauses.

Main submitter: Main person writing the resolution or main presenter of the resolution

- Main submitters deliver a Authorship Speech as well as introduce their resolution to the committee
 - Authorship speeches are essentially a 2 minute speech the main submitter has to talk about their resolution

Co-submitter: everyone else writing or contributing to the resolution

Signatory: delegate who wants the resolution to be discussed

Preambulatory clauses:

- reasons why the committee is acting on a given topic and / or wants to solve the topic.
 - Usual content:
 - relevant legal precedents,
 - relevant United Nations resolutions
 - past international actions on the issue
 - examples why action is needed
- *Always starts with preambulatory phrases , italicized*
- 3-5 clauses per resolution

Examples:

Reaffirming the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the Vienna Declaration and Programme of Action, and recalling relevant international human rights treaties, including the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, and other relevant regional human rights instruments,

Encouraging States to look into their manuals and guidelines used for training law enforcement officers with a view to identifying the proportionality of measures in the handling of suspects and other individuals in custody, with respect to the treatment of people,

Recognizing that national human rights institutions and representatives of civil society, including non-governmental organizations, can play a useful role in facilitating continued dialogue between individuals taking part in peaceful protests and the relevant authorities,

Fully aware of increasing incidents of systemic racism and racial profiling among police forces targeting a specific group of people,

Appreciating the efforts all Member Nations have shown in attempting to solve this crisis through the Sustainable Development Goals

Preambulatory Phrases		
Acknowledging	Noting with approval	Noting with deep concern
Acting	Expressing concern also	Noting with regret
Affirming	Expressing concern	Noting with satisfaction
Alarmed by	Expressing its appreciation	Observing
Alarmed	Expressing its satisfaction	Reaffirming
Anxious	Expressing satisfaction	Reaffirming also
Appreciating	Firmly convinced	Realizing
Approving	Fulfilling	Recalling
Aware of	Fully alarmed	Recalling also
Bearing in mind	Fully aware	Recognizing
Believing	Fully believing	Recognizing also
Cognizant	Further deploring	Recognizing with satisfaction
Concerned	Further recalling	Referring
Confident	Guided by	Regretting
Conscious	Having adopted	Reiterating
Considering	Having considered	Reiterating its call for
Contemplating	Having considered further	Reminding
Convinced	Having devoted attention	Seeking
Declaring	Having examined	Seized
Deeply concerned	Having heard	Stressing
Deeply conscious	Having received	Taking into account
Deeply convinced	Having reviewed	Taking into consideration
Deeply disturbed	Having studied	Taking note
Deeply regretting	Having adopted	Taking note also
Deploring	Having approved	Taking note further
Desiring	Having considered	Underlining
Determined	Having decided	Viewing with appreciation
Emphasizing	Keeping in mind	Viewing with apprehension
Encouraged	Mindful	Welcoming
Expecting	Noting	Welcoming also
Expressing appreciation	Noting further	

Operative clauses:

- Solutions to the issue
- ***Always start with operative phrases, underlined***
- *At least 8 clauses(sub-clauses aren't counted)*

Examples:

1. **Urges** member states to determine a standardised practice of refugee admission through means such as but not limited to:
 - a. agree on a predetermined legal and administrative process in order to reduce the resettlement process duration to help resettle refugees in need in a timely manner while still maintaining the effectiveness and quality of the resettlement assessed,
 - b. The quality of the resettlement process is assessed by looking at the maintained well-being of the refugees as well as the accuracy of the resettlement administration,
2. **Calls for** existing intergovernmental organisations such as the International Organisation Of Migration(IOM), United Nations High Commissioner For Refugees(UNHCR), and others to prepare refugees for resettlement through means such as but not limited to:
 - a. Orienting refugees by conducting trainings that introduces the cultural customs of said nation and as well as legal workshops conducted by experienced agencies for refugees seeking long-term residence of more than 3 months,
 - b. ensure a smooth transition and inclusive integration of refugees;

3. **Requests** that the United Nations along with developed nations with high economic capabilities through indicators such as a gross national income per capita of US\$12,696 or more to support UN agencies dealing with refugees through means such as but not limited to:
 - a. Establishing a United Nations Financing Agency for Refugee Resettlement that provides;
 - i. Necessary resources such as food, shelter, medication, or educational materials to refugees,
 - ii. capability building processes such as;
 - iii. legal and administrative training to government officials working to resettle refugees in host countries,
4. **Calls for** relevant United Nations agencies to do a thorough investigation of instances of trafficking of refugees in all high-immigration countries regardless of income,

Operative Clauses

Accepts	Accepts	Demands	Recalls
Acknowledges	Acknowledges	Deplores	Recognizes
Adopts	Adopts	Designates	Recommends
Advises	Advises	Directs	Regrets
Affirms	Affirms	Draws the attention	Reiterates
Also calls for	Also calls for	Emphasizes	Reminds
Also recommends	Also recommends	Encourages	Renews its appeal
Also strongly condemns	Also strongly condemns	Endorses	Repeats
Also urges	Also urges	Expresses its appreciation	Requests
Appeals	Appeals	Expresses its hope	Requires
Appreciates	Appreciates	Expresses its regret	Solemnly affirms
Approves	Approves	Further invites	Stresses
Authorizes	Authorizes	Further proclaims	Strongly advises
Calls	Calls	Further recommends	Strongly condemns
Calls for	Calls for	Further reminds	Strongly encourages
Calls upon	Calls upon	Further requests	Suggests
Commends	Commends	Further resolves	Supports
Concurs	Concurs	Has resolved	Takes note of
Condemns	Condemns	Instructs	Transmits
Confirms	Confirms	Introduces	Trusts
Congratulates	Congratulates	Invites	Underlines
Considers	Considers	Notes	Underscores
Decides	Decides	Notes with satisfaction	Urges
Declares	Declares	Proclaims	Welcomes
Declares accordingly	Declares accordingly	Reaffirms	

Amendments:

- Any changes you want to make to a resolution being presented
- Amendments must be sent to the Chairs through noteform
 - Adding
 - a new clause
 - a new sub clause
 - a new sub sub clause
 - any additional words to an existing clause or subclause
 - Strike/ Delete
 - clause
 - sub-clause

- sub sub clause

Examples:

Amendment : USA

Strike clause 4

Amendment : Germany

Add a sub sub clause “Médecins Sans Frontières, CARE, Oxfam, Caritas, Save the Children and the International Rescue Committee, as well as smaller local agencies like National Red Cross and Red Crescent Committees” to clause 5 sub clause b

SAMPLE RESOLUTION:

COMMITTEE: United Nations General Assembly 3: Social, Cultural, and Humanitarian

TOPIC: The Question of the Settlement of Refugees

MAIN SUBMITTER: The Federative Republic of Brazil

CO-SUBMITTERS: The Kingdom of Norway, Netherlands, Russian Federation, United Kingdom, The Republic of Ireland, Kazakhstan, New Zealand, Argentina, United Arab Emirates, Belgium

SIGNATORIES: Switzerland

THE UNITED NATIONS HIGH COMMISSIONER FOR REFUGEES,

Reaffirming the United Nations Universal Declaration of Human Rights Article 14 subclause 1 that states, “Everyone has the right to seek and to enjoy in other countries asylum from persecution;” subclause 2 states, “This right may not be invoked in the case of prosecutions genuinely arising from non-political crimes or from acts contrary to the purposes and principles of the United Nations,”

Recognizing the 1951 Refugee Convention that seeks to promote protection, asylum, and welfare services for refugees and to ensure their human rights and freedom granted by the receiving nation,

Keeping in mind that 85% of refugees flee to developing countries which may not have the capability to support them,

Emphasising the need to support refugees as they as well should have the access to basic human rights

1. **Urges** member states to determine a standardised practice of refugee admission through means such as but not limited to:
 - a. agree on a predetermined legal and administrative process in order to reduce the resettlement process duration to help resettle refugees in need in a timely manner while still maintaining the effectiveness and quality of the resettlement assessed
 - b. The quality of the resettlement process is assess by looking at the maintained well-being of the refugees as well as the accuracy of the resettlement administration
2. **Calls for** existing intergovernmental organisations such as the International Organisation Of Migration(IOM), United Nations High Commissioner For Refugees(UNHCR), and others to prepare refugees for resettlement through means such as but not limited to:
 - a. Orienting refugees by conducting trainings that introduces the cultural customs of said nation and as well as legal workshops conducted by experienced agencies for refugees seeking long-term residence of more than 3 months.
 - b. ensure a smooth transition and inclusive integration of refugees;

3. **Requests** that the United Nations along with developed nations with high economic capabilities through indicators such as a gross national income per capita of US\$12,696 or more to support UN agencies dealing with refugees through means such as but not limited to:
 - a. Establishing a United Nations Financing Agency for Refugee Resettlement that provides
 - i. Necessary resources such as food, shelter, medication, or educational materials to refugees
 - ii. capability building processes such as
 - iii. legal and administrative training to government officials working to resettle refugees in host countries
4. **Calls for** relevant United Nations agencies to do a thorough investigation of instances of trafficking of refugees in all high-immigration countries regardless of income.
5. **Promotes** the resettlement of refugees in high-income countries to ease the burden of refugees in low to middle-income countries with the help of:
 - a. High-income countries being required to set aside temporary shelters for any and all refugees who come seeking asylum in host countries in high income.
 - b. Support from Non-Governmental Organisations that specialise in helping refugees
 - c. Charity organisations that help refugees
 - d. Refugee support organisations;

THIMUN GLOSSARY

Term	Definition	Usage of Term
Abstain	When voting on a draft resolution or amendment, a delegate may refrain from voting yes or no by choosing to abstain.	“Any delegates wishing to abstain please raise your placards high.”
Adjourn	Means that session time has ended (usually committees will be adjourned either for a break, lunch, or the day).	“Motion to adjourn meeting.”
Admin Staff	Conference staff positioned in committees to help with miscellaneous actions, such as note passing	“The admin staff will pass the notes for the delegates.”

Chair Report	A document containing information about the topic sent to delegates to prepare them for the conference.	“The background guide should provide delegates information on the topic.”
Bloc	A group of member states cooperating to articulate ideas.	“Several blocs had formed during the second session.”
Chair	Moderates the conference and enforces the debate.	“The Chair would suggest delegates to share their thoughts through means of speech.”
Delegate	A student representing a member state, observer, or organization at a conference.	“The Delegate of Germany motions for an unmoderated caucus.”
Delegation	The entire population representing a member state, observer, or organization in a committee.	“This Delegation believes that draft resolution 1.1 is beneficial to all nations.”
Draft Resolution	A document aiming to solve the problems posed by the committee; if it passes, it becomes a resolution adopted by the United Nations.	“Our bloc’s draft resolution is comprehensive and feasible.”
First Degree Amendment	An amendment that a delegate adds to either add, delete, or revise a clause in the resolution to better the resolution as a whole.	“This delegate has submitted an amendment to the first degree.”
Gavel	Small wooden hammer used by the Chairs to bring order to the committee.	“The chair will bang the gavel once at 45 seconds and twice at 1 minute.”
Main Submitter	Usually, the delegate that is the leader of the bloc, facilitated discussions during lobbying time and drafted most	“May the main submitter of this resolution please approach the podium and

	of the clauses. This delegate reads out the operative clauses before debating on the resolution as a whole and delivers the first speech on the resolution.	read out the operative clauses.”
Member State	A country that has ratified the Charter of the United Nations and whose application to join has been accepted by the General Assembly and Security Council.	“Currently, there are currently 193 member states in the United Nations.”
Motion	A specific request made by delegates that may alter the flow of debate. Examples include moderated caucus, unmoderated caucus, suspension of the meeting, adjournment of the meeting, closure of the debate, and move to the previous question.	“Delegates may move for motions and they will be voted upon.”
Note Passing	A note that delegates can send to other delegates in the committee during debate and is passed around by the admin staff. However, it is usually screened by the chairs for appropriateness.	“Is note passing in order during this session?”
Observer	A state, national organization, regional organization, or non-governmental organization that is not a member of the United Nations but participates in its debates. Observers can vote on procedural matters (such as motions) but not substantive matters (such as draft resolutions and amendments).	“Permanent observers of the UN include the Holy See and Palestine.”
On the Floor	The formal platform and stage where debates and speeches are given.	“Are there any points or motions on the floor?”
Operative	Statements made in the second section	“Please read out the

Clauses	of a draft resolution that details the specific actions sponsors wish to put forth. It has to start with a verb in any form necessary.	operative clauses of the draft resolution.”
Placard	A sign with a delegate’s country’s name printed on it.	“Delegates that wish to be added to the general speaker’s list, please raise your placards high.”
Point	A specific request made by a delegate to the Chairs, including: point of order, point of personal privilege, and point of personal inquiry.	“Point of personal privilege: could the delegate of the Russian Federation please speak louder?”
Preambulatory Clauses	Statements made in the first section of a draft resolution that outlines the main problems faced and past actions taken.	“The delegate of DPRK believes that the preambulatory clauses of this draft resolution are too repetitive.”
Procedural Vote	Voting concerning the flow of debate, such as those of motions.	“Delegates, this is a procedural vote, thus meaning all delegates are required to vote on this.”
Right to Reply	A reply to a speaker’s comment. It is usually requested by a delegate when he or she feels offended or wishes to reply to a delegate’s speech.	“Are there any rights of reply on the floor?”
Roll Call	When the Chair reads aloud all the names of participating delegations in alphabetical order to record if they are present or present and voting (or to record their votes in a Roll Call vote).	“The chair will now be taking roll call. When your delegation is called, please raise your placards and say present or present and voting.”
Rules of	The rules by which a Model UN	“Delegates are required to

Procedures	committee is run.	follow the rule of procedures during all sessions.”
Second	To vocally agree to a motion.	“The delegate has raised a motion to suspend the meeting. Are there any seconds?”
Second Degree Amendment	Amendments that request changes to a first amendment. They can only be submitted during “time against” the first amendment.	“This delegate has submitted an amendment to the second degree.”
Secretariat	The hosting team of the conference.	“We should all thank the Secretariat for their hard work in organizing the conference!”
Secretary General	The leader of a conference.	“We love our Secretary General so much we bought her donuts!”
Signatory/ Co-submitters	A country that wishes a draft resolution to be put on the floor and signs the draft resolution to accomplish this. A signatory need not support a resolution; it only wants it to be discussed.	“A number of X signatories must be acquired for a draft resolution for the document to be valid.”
Simple Majority	Fifty percent of the committee plus one delegate (used to pass most votes).	“Since a simple majority has passed, this motion passes.”
Substantive Vote	Votes concerning the passage of a document, such as a draft resolution or amendment.	“In the substantive vote, delegates are allowed to vote yes, no, pass or abstain.”
Veto	The ability, held by China, France, the	“China possesses veto rights.

	Russian Federation, the United Kingdom, and the United States to prevent any draft resolution in the Security Council from passing by voting no.	That is, it has the right to prevent a draft resolution from passing.”
Yield	The process of giving the floor to another delegate or back to the chair.	“This delegate would like to yield the floor to the delegate of the Republic of Korea.”

References:

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